

Application Layer

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Learning Objectives

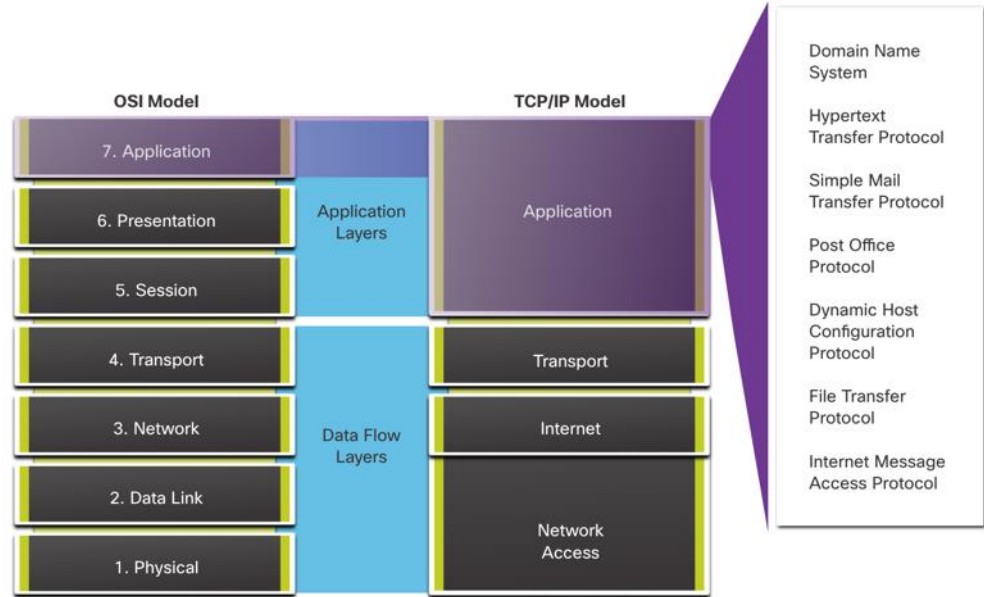
- To understand how the functions of the application layer, presentation layer, and session layer work together to provide network services to end user applications
- To understand and configure DNS and DHCP operations on a router.

Application, Presentation, and Session

Application, Presentation, and Session

Application Layer

- The upper three layers of the OSI model (application, presentation, and session) define functions of the TCP/IP application layer.
- The application layer provides the interface between the applications used to communicate, and the underlying network over which messages are transmitted.
- Some of the most widely known application layer protocols include HTTP, FTP, TFTP, IMAP and DNS.



Application, Presentation, and Session

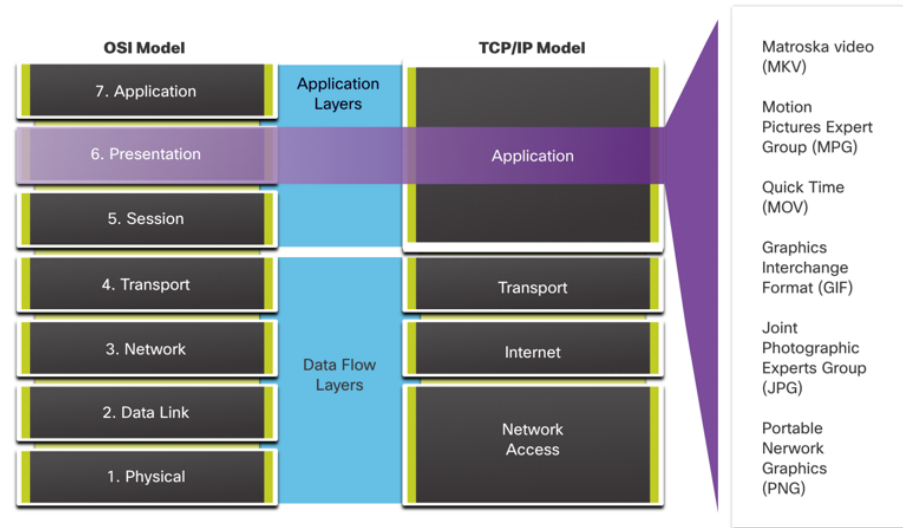
Presentation and Session Layer

The presentation layer has three primary functions:

- Formatting, or presenting, data at the source device into a compatible format for receipt by the destination device
- Compressing data in a way that can be decompressed by the destination device
- Encrypting data for transmission and decrypting data upon receipt

The session layer functions:

- It creates and maintains dialogs between source and destination applications.
- It handles the exchange of information to initiate dialogs, keep them active, and to restart sessions that are disrupted or idle for a long period of time.



TCP/IP Application Layer Protocols

- The TCP/IP application protocols specify the format and control information necessary for many common internet communication functions.
- Application layer protocols are used by both the source and destination devices during a communication session.
- For the communications to be successful, the application layer protocols that are implemented on the source and destination host must be compatible.

Name System

DNS - Domain Name System (or Service)

- TCP, UDP client 53
- Translates domain names, such as cisco.com, into IP addresses.

Host Config

DHCP - Dynamic Host Configuration Protocol

- UDP client 68, server 67
- Dynamically assigns IP addresses to be re-used when no longer needed

Web

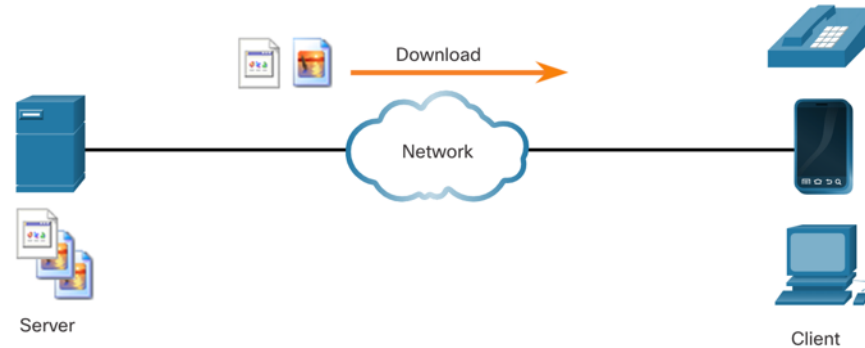
HTTP - Hypertext Transfer Protocol

- TCP 80, 8080
- A set of rules for exchanging text, graphic images, sound, video, and other multimedia files on the World Wide Web

Peer-to-Peer

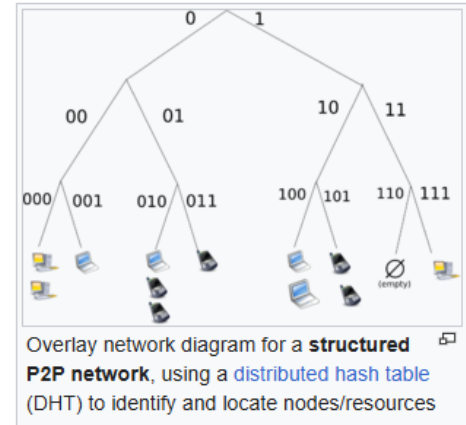
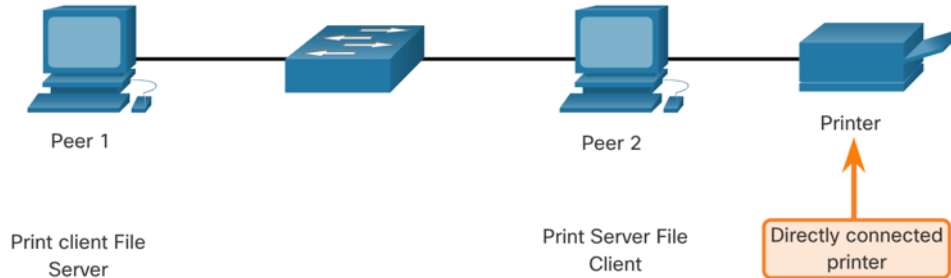
Client-Server Model

- Client and server processes are considered to be in the application layer.
- In the client/server model, the device requesting the information is called a client and the device responding to the request is called a server.
- Application layer protocols describe the format of the requests and responses between clients and servers.



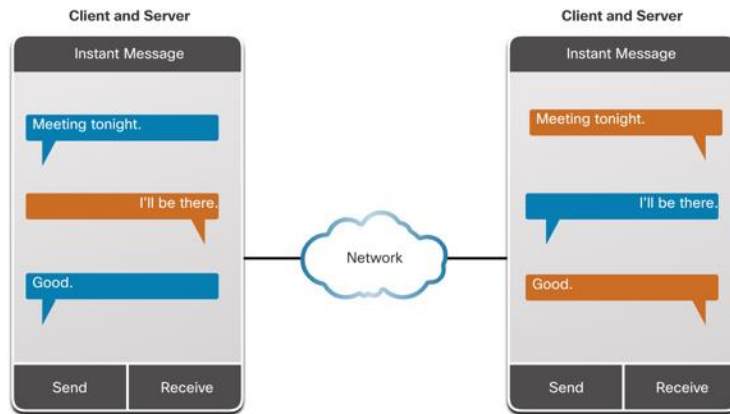
Peer-to-Peer Networks

- In a peer-to-peer (P2P) network, two or more computers are connected via a network and can share resources (such as printers and files) without having a dedicated server.
- Every connected end device (known as a peer) can function as both a server and a client.
- One computer might assume the role of server for one transaction while simultaneously serving as a client for another. The roles of client and server are set on a per request basis.



Peer-to-Peer Applications

- A P2P application allows a device to act as both a client and a server within the same communication.
- Some P2P applications use a hybrid system where each peer accesses an index server to get the location of a resource stored on another peer.

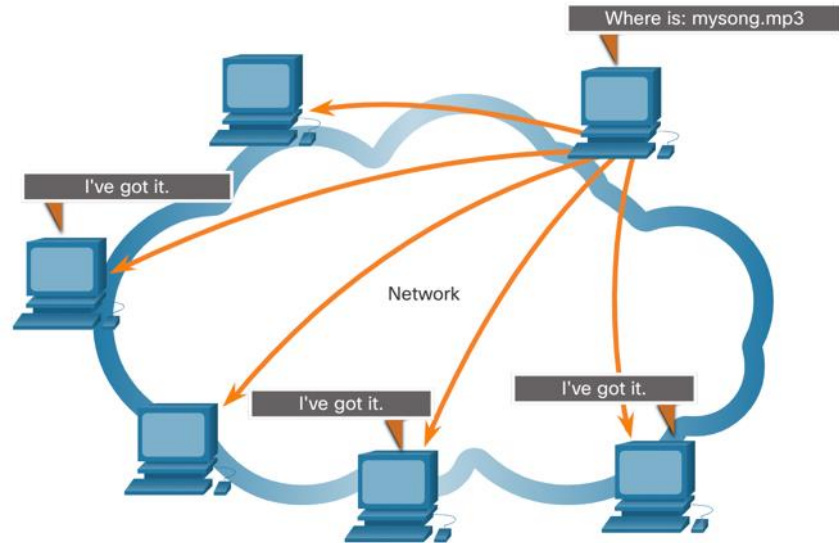


Common P2P Applications

With P2P applications, each computer in the network that is running the application can act as a client or a server for the other computers in the network that are also running the application.

Common P2P networks include the following:

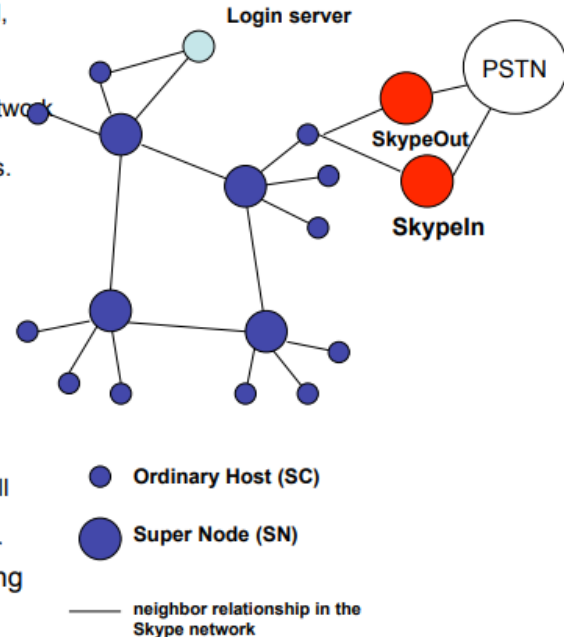
- BitTorrent
- Direct Connect
- eDonkey
- Freenet



P2P Example – Skype Architecture

- Login
- User Search
- Start and end calls
- Media Transfer
- Presence messages

- Skype client (SC)
 - which is an application to start/receive calls, IM, send/receive files
- Super nodes (SN)
 - any node with sufficient CPU, memory, and network bandwidth can become a SN.
 - A SC can become a SN - and can't prevent this.
- Login server (LS)
 - stores user's profile and performs users authentication
 - Implements a public key infrastructure (PKI)
 - Infrastructure with clients
- Gateways
 - SkypeIn and SkypeOut servers provide PC-to-PSTN and PSTN-to-PC bridging, respectively
- Tricks
 - Network Address Translation (NAT) and firewall traversals are important Skype functions
- TCP for signaling, and both UDP and TCP for transporting media - different ports for signaling and data transfer
- Wideband codec for 5-32 kbps
- Unique skype user names across system



Web and Email Protocols

Hypertext Transfer Protocol and Hypertext Markup Language

When a web address or Uniform Resource Locator (URL) is typed into a web browser, the web browser establishes a connection to the web service. The web service is running on the server that is using the HTTP protocol.

To better understand how the web browser and web server interact, examine how a web page is opened in a browser.

Step 1

The browser interprets the three parts of the URL:

- http (the protocol or scheme)
- www.cisco.com (the server name)
- index.html (the specific filename requested)

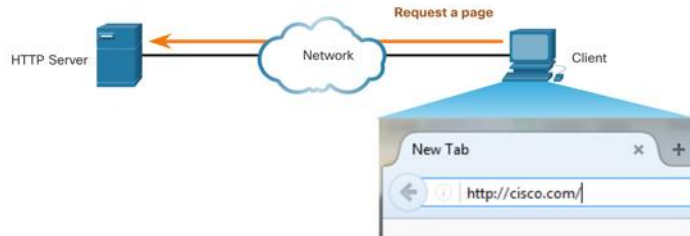


Hypertext Transfer Protocol and Hypertext Markup Language (Cont.)

Step 2

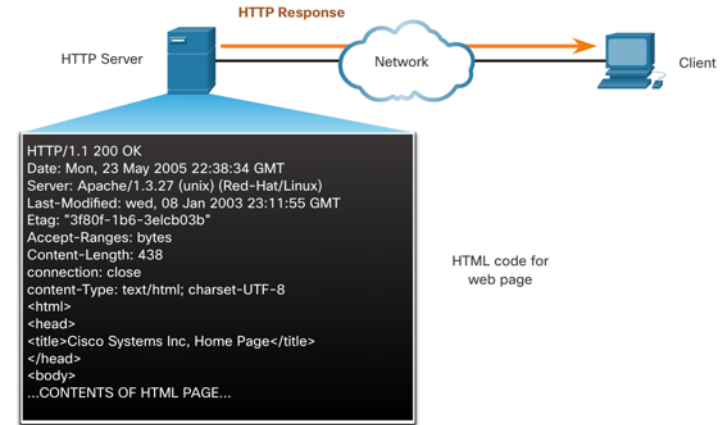
The browser then checks with a name server to convert `www.cisco.com` into a numeric IP address, which it uses to connect to the server.

The client initiates an HTTP request to a server by sending a GET request to the server and asks for the `index.html` file.



Step 3

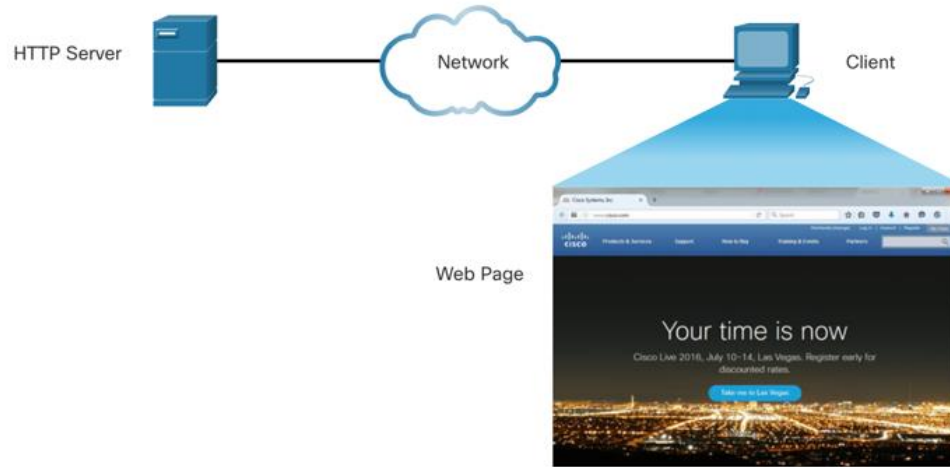
In response to the request, the server sends the HTML code for this web page to the browser.



Hypertext Transfer Protocol and Hypertext Markup Language (Cont.)

Step 4

The browser deciphers the HTML code and formats the page for the browser window.



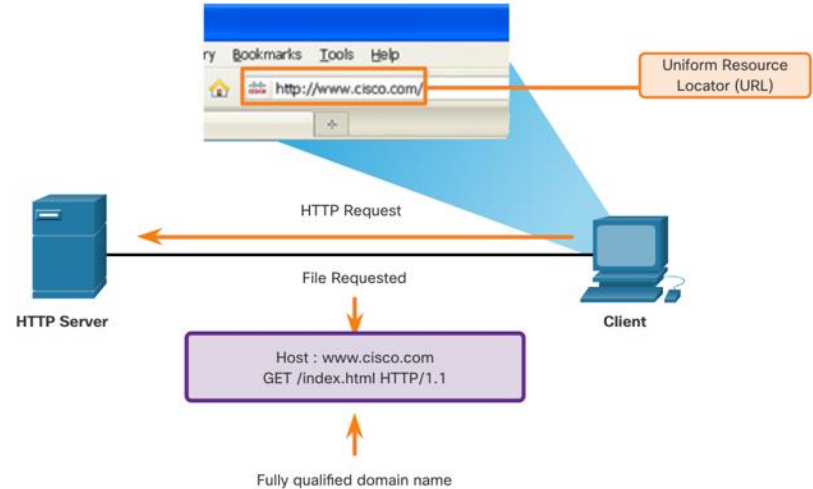
Web and Email Protocols

HTTP and HTTPS

HTTP is a request/response protocol that specifies the message types used for that communication.

The three common message types are GET, POST, and PUT:

- **GET** - This is a client request for data. A client (web browser) sends the GET message to the web server to request HTML pages.
- **POST** - This uploads data files to the web server, such as form data.
- **PUT** - This uploads resources or content to the web server, such as an image.



Note: HTTP is not a secure protocol. For secure communications sent across the internet, HTTPS should be used.

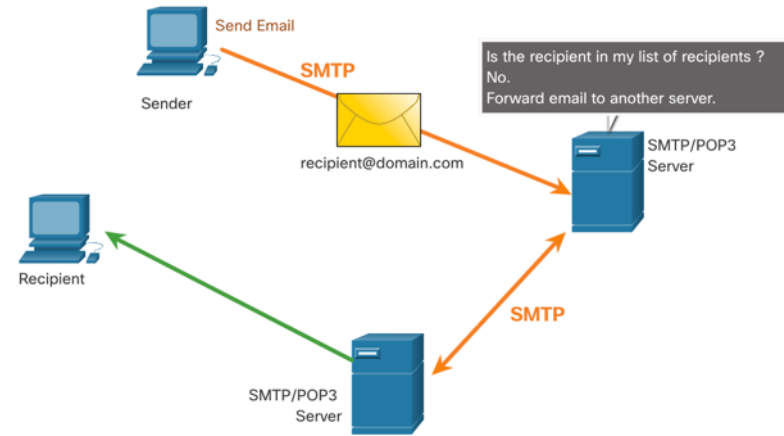
Email Protocols

The email protocols used for operation are:

-
- The diagram illustrates the flow of an email from a sender to a recipient. It shows the following components and connections:
- Sender:** A person at a computer on the left. A speech bubble indicates the command: "Send to recipient@cisco.com".
 - ISP A Mail Server:** A blue server icon connected to the sender's network via a router.
 - SMTP:** An orange envelope icon at the top, representing the Simple Mail Transfer Protocol.
 - ISP B Mail Server:** A blue server icon connected to the recipient's network via a router.
 - IMAP or POP3:** A green text label indicating the protocol used for the recipient to retrieve the email.
 - Internet:** A central cloud icon representing the network connecting the two ISPs.
- The flow of the email is as follows:
- The sender initiates the process by sending the email to the ISP A Mail Server.
 - The email is then sent from the ISP A Mail Server to the SMTP icon.
 - The email is then sent from the SMTP icon to the ISP B Mail Server.
 - The email is finally retrieved from the ISP B Mail Server by the recipient using IMAP or POP3.

SMTP, POP and IMAP

- When a client sends email, the client SMTP process connects with a server SMTP process on well-known port 25.
- After the connection is made, the client attempts to send the email to the server across the connection.
- When the server receives the message, it either places the message in a local account, if the recipient is local, or forwards the message to another mail server for delivery.
- The destination email server may not be online or may be busy. If so, SMTP spools messages to be sent at a later time.

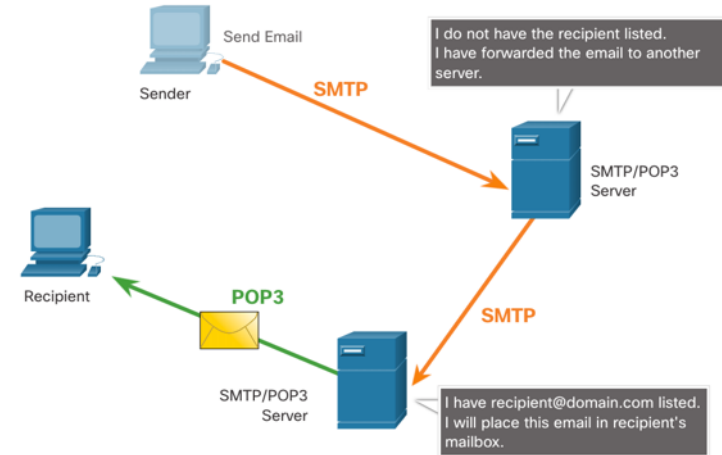


Note: SMTP message formats require a message header (recipient email address & sender email address) and a message body.

SMTP, POP and IMAP (Cont.)

POP is used by an application to retrieve mail from a mail server. When mail is downloaded from the server to the client using POP the messages are then deleted on the server.

- The server starts the POP service by passively listening on TCP port 110 for client connection requests.
- When a client wants to make use of the service, it sends a request to establish a TCP connection with the server.
- When the connection is established, the POP server sends a greeting.
- The client and POP server then exchange commands and responses until the connection is closed or aborted.

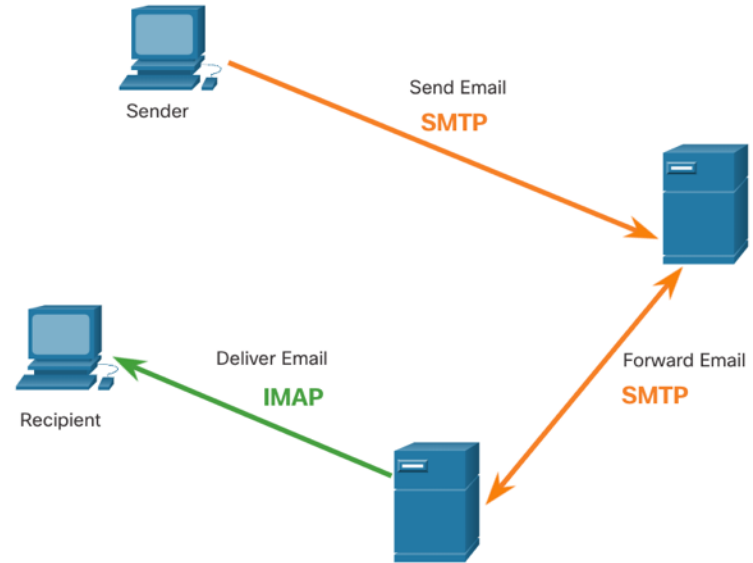


Note: Since POP does not store messages, it is not recommended for small businesses that need a centralized backup solution.

SMTP, POP and IMAP (Cont.)

IMAP is another protocol that describes a method to retrieve email messages.

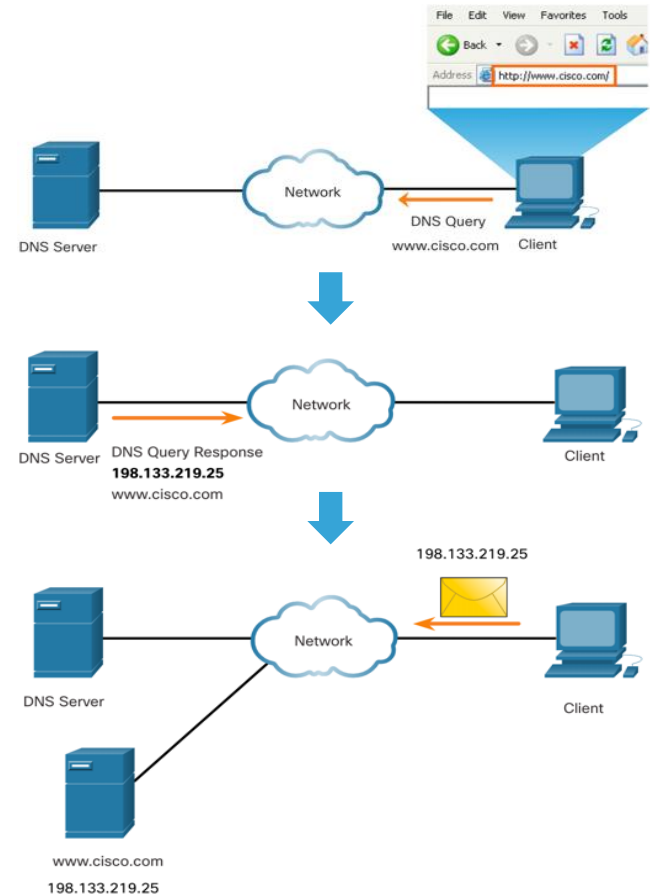
- Unlike POP, when a user connects to an IMAP server, copies of the messages are downloaded to the client application. The original messages are kept on the server until manually deleted.
- When a user decides to delete a message, the server synchronizes that action and deletes the message from the server.



IP Addressing Services

Domain Name Service

- Domain names were created to convert the numeric IP addresses into a simple, recognizable name.
- Fully-qualified domain names (FQDNs), such as `http://www.cisco.com`, are much easier for people to remember than `198.133.219.25`.
- The DNS protocol defines an automated service that matches resource names with the required numeric network address. It includes the format for queries, responses, and data.



DNS Message Format

The DNS server stores different types of resource records that are used to resolve names. These records contain the name, address, and type of record.

Some of these record types are as follows:

- **A** - An end device IPv4 address
- **NS** - An authoritative name server
- **AAAA** - An end device IPv6 address (pronounced quad-A)
- **MX** - A mail exchange record

When a client makes a query, the server DNS process first looks at its own records to resolve the name. If it is unable to resolve the name by using its stored records, it contacts other servers to resolve the name.

After a match is found and returned to the original requesting server, the server temporarily stores the numbered address in the event that the same name is requested again.

DNS Message Format (Cont.)

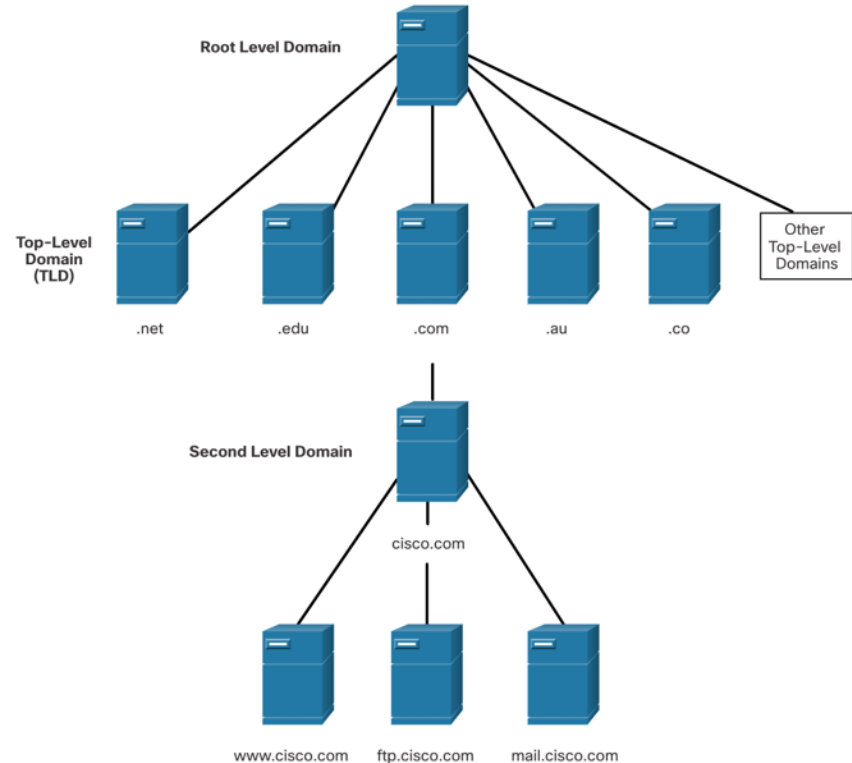
DNS uses the same message format between servers, consisting of a question, answer, authority, and additional information for all types of client queries and server responses, error messages, and transfer of resource record information.

DNS message section	Description
Question	The question for the name server
Answer	Resource Records answering the question
Authority	Resource Records pointing toward an authority
Additional	Resource Records holding additional information

IP Addressing Services

DNS Hierarchy

- DNS uses a hierarchical system to create a database to provide name resolution.
- Each DNS server maintains a specific database file and is only responsible for managing name-to-IP mappings for that small portion of the entire DNS structure.
- When a DNS server receives a request for a name translation that is not within its DNS zone, the DNS server forwards the request to another DNS server within the proper zone for translation.
- Examples of top-level domains:
 - **.com** - a business or industry
 - **.org** - a non-profit organization
 - **.au** - Australia



The nslookup Command

- Nslookup is a computer operating system utility that allows a user to manually query the DNS servers configured on the device to resolve a given host name.
- This utility can also be used to troubleshoot name resolution issues and to verify the current status of the name servers.
- When the **nslookup** command is issued, the default DNS server configured for your host is displayed.
- The name of a host or domain can be entered at the **nslookup** prompt.

```
C:\Users> nslookup
Default Server:  dns-sj.cisco.com
Address:  171.70.168.183
> www.cisco.com
Server:  dns-sj.cisco.com
Address:  171.70.168.183
Name:  origin-www.cisco.com
Addresses:  2001:420:1101:1::a
           173.37.145.84
Aliases:  www.cisco.com
> cisco.netacad.net
Server:  dns-sj.cisco.com
Address:  171.70.168.183
Name:  cisco.netacad.net
Address:  72.163.6.223
>
```

File Sharing Services

File Transfer Protocol

FTP was developed to allow for data transfers between a client and a server. An FTP client is an application which runs on a computer that is being used to push and pull data from an FTP server.



1. Control Connection:

Client opens first connection to the server for control traffic.



2. Data Connection:

Client opens second connection for data traffic.



Step 1 - The client establishes the first connection to the server for control traffic using TCP port 21. The traffic consists of client commands and server replies.

Step 2 - The client establishes the second connection to the server for the actual data transfer using TCP port 20. This connection is created every time there is data to be transferred.

Step 3 - The data transfer can happen in either direction. The client can download (pull) data from the server, or the client can upload (push) data to the server.

File Sharing Services

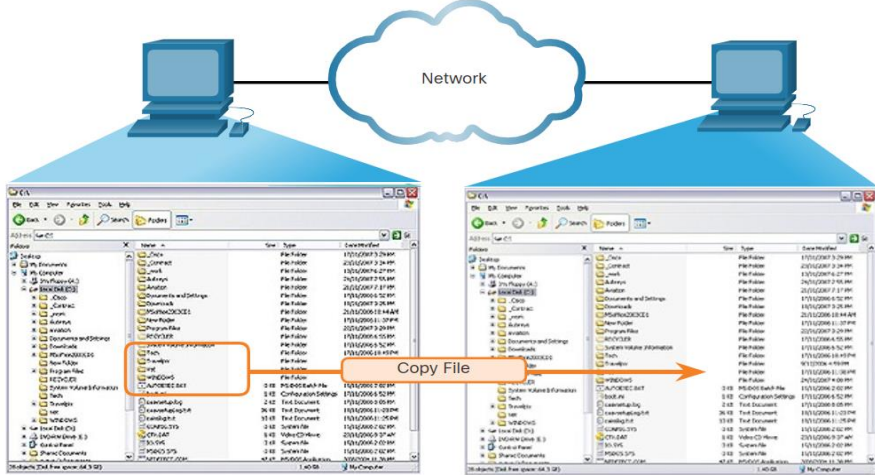
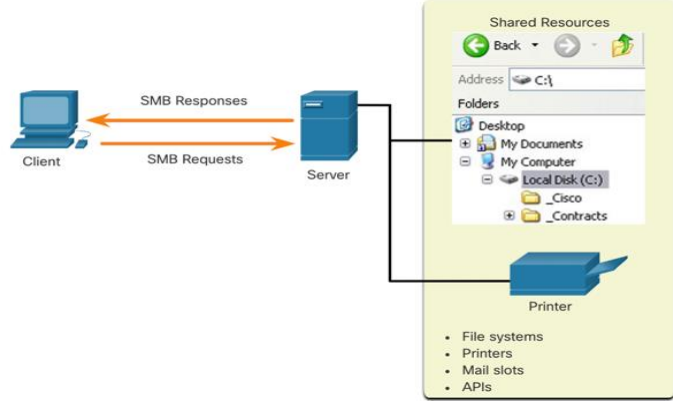
Server Message Block

The Server Message Block (SMB) is a client/server, request-response file sharing protocol. Servers can make their own resources available to clients on the network.

Three functions of SMB messages:

- Start, authenticate, and terminate sessions
- Control file and printer access
- Allow an application to send or receive messages to or from another device

Unlike the file sharing supported by FTP, clients establish a long-term connection to servers. After the connection is established, the user of the client can access the resources on the server as though the resource is local to the client host.

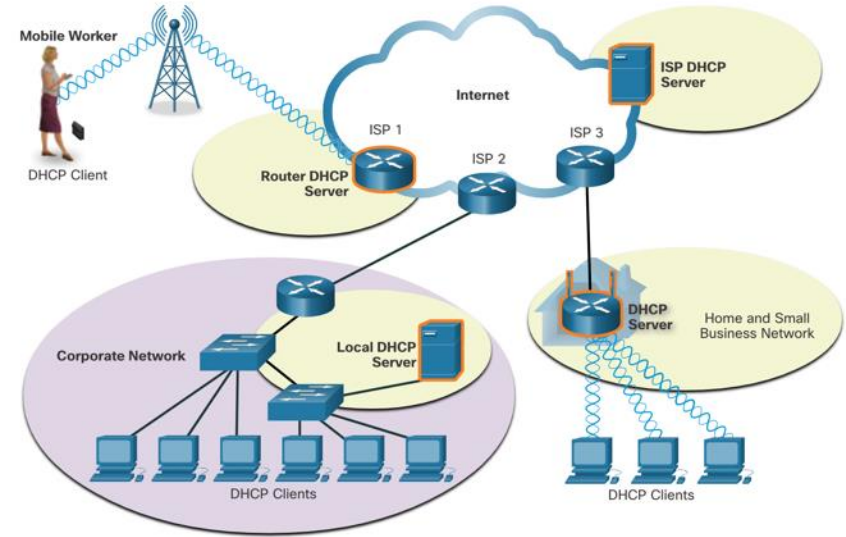


A file may be copied from PC to PC with Windows Explorer using the SMB protocol.

DHCPv4 Concepts

Dynamic Host Configuration Protocol

- The Dynamic Host Configuration Protocol (DHCP) for IPv4 service automates the assignment of IPv4 addresses, subnet masks, gateways, and other IPv4 networking parameters.
- DHCP is considered dynamic addressing compared to static addressing. Static addressing is manually entering IP address information.
- When a host connects to the network, the DHCP server is contacted, and an address is requested. The DHCP server chooses an address from a configured range of addresses called a pool and assigns (leases) it to the host.
- Many networks use both DHCP and static addressing. DHCP is used for general purpose hosts, such as end user devices. Static addressing is used for network devices, such as gateway routers, switches, servers, and printers.



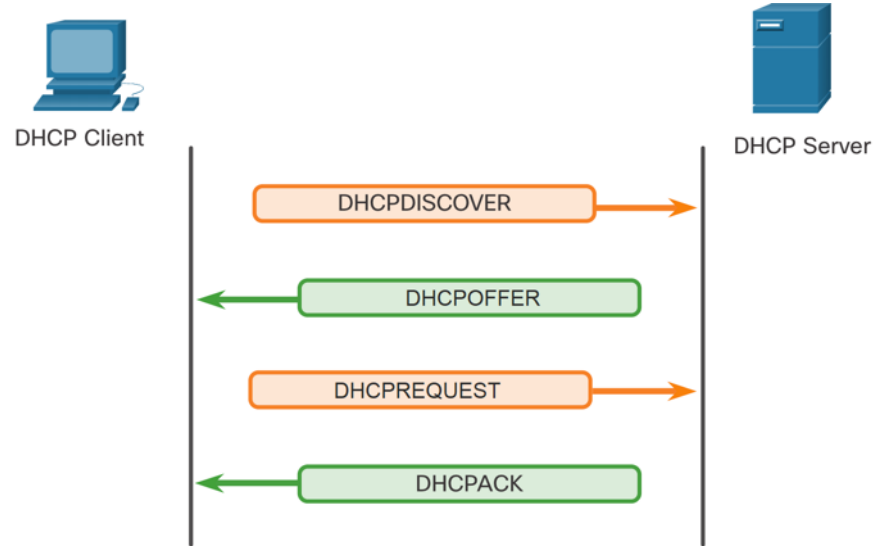
Note: DHCP for IPv6 (DHCPv6) provides similar services for IPv6 clients. However, DHCPv6 does not provide a default gateway address. This can only be obtained dynamically from the Router Advertisement message of the router.

IP Addressing Services

DHCP Operation

The DHCP Process:

- When an IPv4, DHCP-configured device boots up or connects to the network, the client broadcasts a DHCP discover (DHCPDISCOVER) message to identify any available DHCP servers on the network.
- A DHCP server replies with a DHCP offer (DHCPOFFER) message, which offers a lease to the client. (If a client receives more than one offer due to multiple DHCP servers on the network, it must choose one.)
- The client sends a DHCP request (DHCPREQUEST) message that identifies the explicit server and lease offer that the client is accepting.
- The server then returns a DHCP acknowledgment (DHCPACK) message that acknowledges to the client that the lease has been finalized.
- If the offer is no longer valid, then the selected server responds with a DHCP negative acknowledgment (DHCPNAK) message and the process must begin with a new DHCPDISCOVER message.



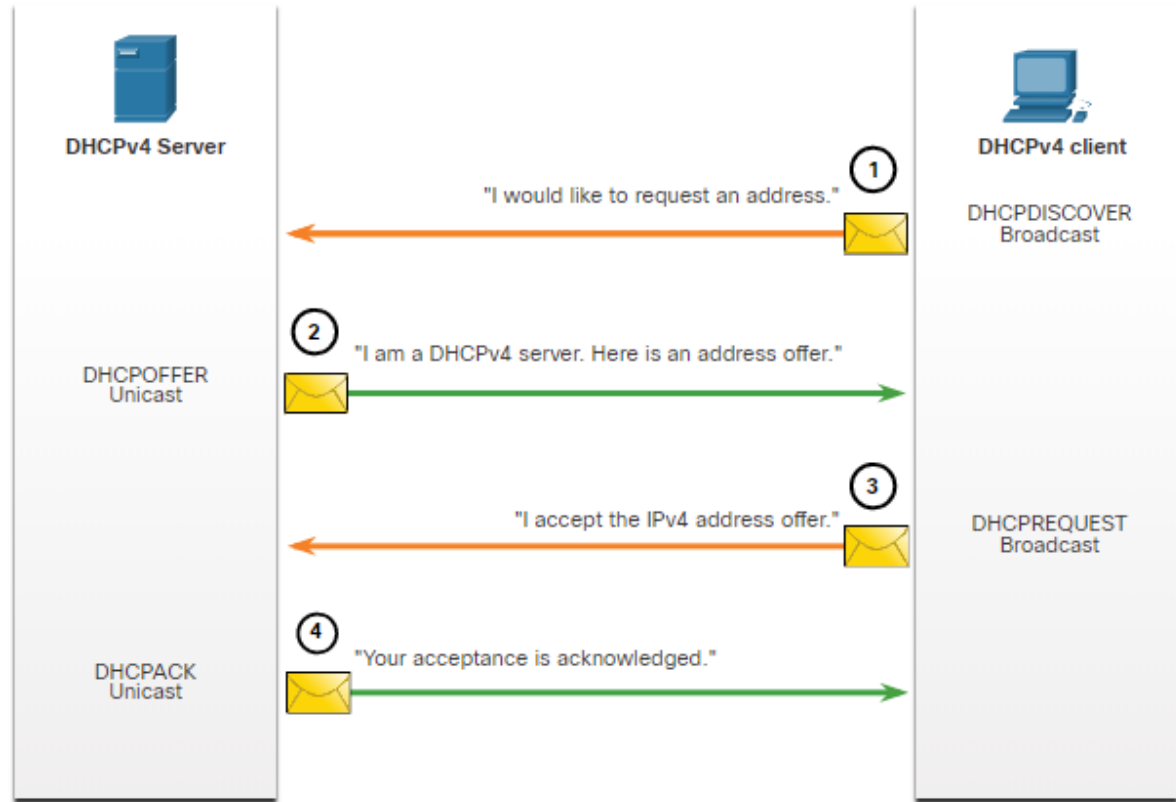
Note: DHCPv6 has a set of messages that is similar to those for DHCPv4. The DHCPv6 messages are SOLICIT, ADVERTISE, INFORMATION REQUEST, and REPLY.

DHCPv4 Concepts

Steps to Obtain a Lease

When the client boots (or otherwise wants to join a network), it begins a four-step process to obtain a lease:

1. DHCP Discover (DHCPDISCOVER)
2. DHCP Offer (DHCPOFFER)
3. DHCP Request (DHCPREQUEST)
4. DHCP Acknowledgment (DHCPACK)



DHCPv4 Concepts

Steps to Renew a Lease

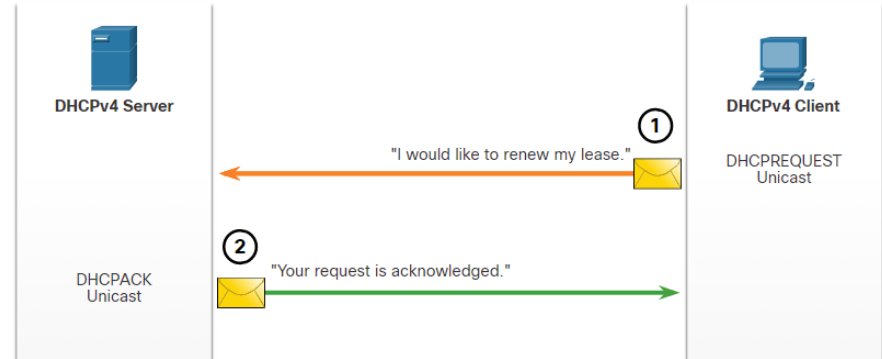
Prior to lease expiration, the client begins a two-step process to renew the lease with the DHCPv4 server, as shown in the figure:

1. DHCP Request (DHCPREQUEST)

Before the lease expires, the client sends a DHCPREQUEST message directly to the DHCPv4 server that originally offered the IPv4 address. If a DHCPACK is not received within a specified amount of time, the client broadcasts another DHCPREQUEST so that one of the other DHCPv4 servers can extend the lease.

2. DHCP Acknowledgment (DHCPACK)

On receiving the DHCPREQUEST message, the server verifies the lease information by returning a DHCPACK.



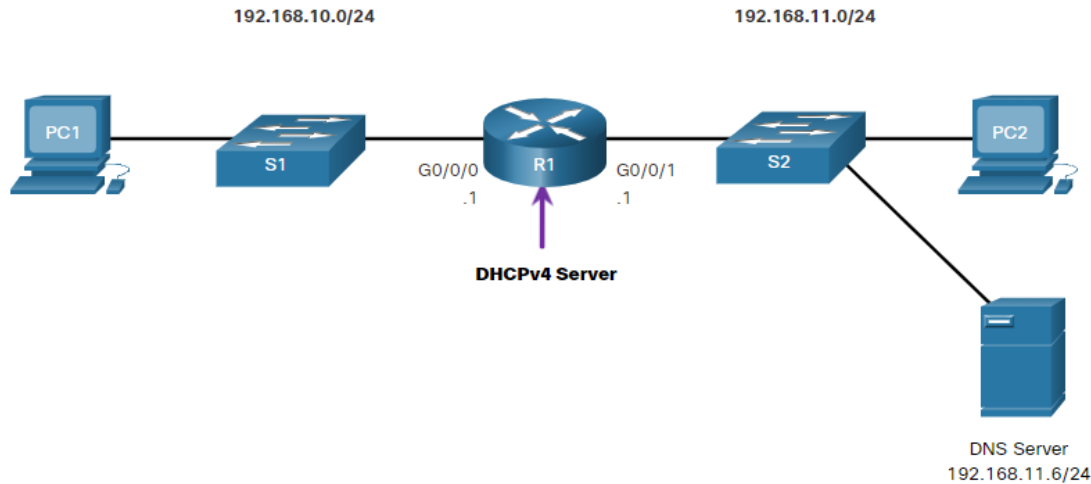
Note: These messages (primarily the DHCP OFFER and DHCPACK) can be sent as unicast or broadcast according to IETF RFC 2131.

Configure a Cisco IOS DHCPv4 Server

Configure a Cisco IOS DHCPv4 Server

Cisco IOS DHCPv4 Server

A Cisco router running Cisco IOS software can be configured to act as a DHCPv4 server. The Cisco IOS DHCPv4 server assigns and manages IPv4 addresses from specified address pools within the router to DHCPv4 clients.



Steps to Configure a Cisco IOS DHCPv4 Server

Use the following steps to configure a Cisco IOS DHCPv4 server:

- **Step 1.** Exclude IPv4 addresses. A single address or a range of addresses can be excluded by specifying the *low-address* and *high-address* of the range. Excluded addresses should be those addresses that are assigned to routers, servers, printers, and other devices that have been, or will be, manually configured. You can also enter the command multiple times. The command is **ip dhcp excluded-address *low-address* [*high-address*]**

```
Router(config)# ip dhcp excluded-address low-address [high-address]
```

- **Step 2.** Define a DHCPv4 pool name. The **ip dhcp pool *pool-name*** command creates a pool with the specified name and puts the router in DHCPv4 configuration mode, which is identified by the prompt **Router(dhcp-config)#**.

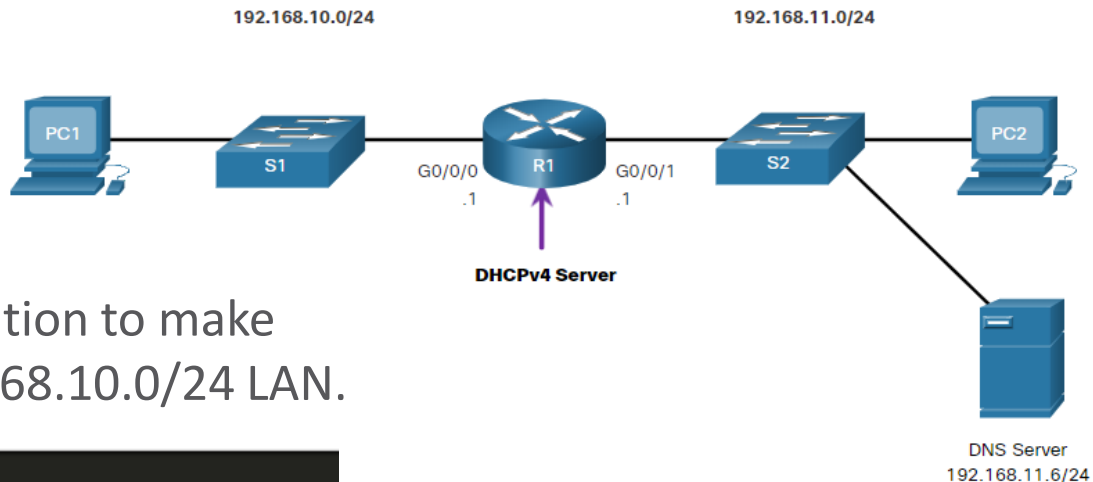
```
Router(config)# ip dhcp pool pool-name  
Router(dhcp-config)#
```

Steps to Configure a Cisco IOS DHCPv4 Server (Cont.)

- **Step 3.** Configure the DHCPv4 pool. The address pool and default gateway router must be configured. Use the **network** statement to define the range of available addresses. Use the **default-router** command to define the default gateway router. These commands and other optional commands are shown in the table.

Task	IOS Command
Define the address pool.	network <i>network-number</i> [<i>mask</i> / <i>prefix-length</i>]
Define the default router or gateway.	default-router <i>address</i> [<i>address2</i> <i>address8</i>]
Define a DNS server.	dns-server <i>address</i> [<i>address2</i> ... <i>address8</i>]
Define the domain name.	domain-name <i>domain</i>
Define the duration of the DHCP lease.	lease { <i>days</i> [<i>hours</i> [<i>minutes</i>]] infinite }
Define the NetBIOS WINS server.	netbios-name-server <i>address</i> [<i>address2</i> ... <i>address8</i>]

Configure a Cisco IOS DHCPv4 Server Configuration Example



The example shows the configuration to make R1 a DHCPv4 server for the 192.168.10.0/24 LAN.

```
R1(config)# ip dhcp excluded-address 192.168.10.1 192.168.10.9
R1(config)# ip dhcp excluded-address 192.168.10.254
R1(config)# ip dhcp pool LAN-POOL-1
R1(dhcp-config)# network 192.168.10.0 255.255.255.0
R1(dhcp-config)# default-router 192.168.10.1
R1(dhcp-config)# dns-server 192.168.11.5
R1(dhcp-config)# domain-name example.com
R1(dhcp-config)# end
R1#
```

Configure a Cisco IOS DHCPv4 Server

DHCPv4 Verification

Use the commands in the table to verify that the Cisco IOS DHCPv4 server is operational.

Command	Description
show running-config section dhcp	Displays the DHCPv4 commands configured on the router.
show ip dhcp binding	Displays a list of all IPv4 address to MAC address bindings provided by the DHCPv4 service.
show ip dhcp server statistics	Displays count information regarding the number of DHCPv4 messages that have been sent and received

Configure a Cisco IOS DHCPv4 Server

Verify DHCPv4 is Operational

Verify the DHCPv4 Configuration: As shown in the example, the **show running-config | section dhcp** command output displays the DHCPv4 commands configured on R1. The **| section** parameter displays only the commands associated with DHCPv4 configuration.

```
R1# show running-config | section dhcp
ip dhcp excluded-address 192.168.10.1 192.168.10.9
ip dhcp excluded-address 192.168.10.254
ip dhcp pool LAN-POOL-1
  network 192.168.10.0 255.255.255.0
  default-router 192.168.10.1
  dns-server 192.168.11.5
  domain-name example.com
```

Configure a Cisco IOS DHCPv4 Server

Verify DHCPv4 is Operational (Cont.)

Verify DHCPv4 Bindings: As shown in the example, the operation of DHCPv4 can be verified using the **show ip dhcp binding** command. This command displays a list of all IPv4 address to MAC address bindings that have been provided by the DHCPv4 service.

```
R1# show ip dhcp binding
Bindings from all pools not associated with VRF:
IP address      Client-ID/      Lease expiration    Type      State      Interface
                Hardware address/
                User name
192.168.10.10    0100.5056.b3ed.d8  Sep 15 2019 8:42 AM  Automatic Active
GigabitEthernet0/0/0
```

Configure a Cisco IOS DHCPv4 Server

Verify DHCPv4 is Operational (Cont.)

Verify DHCPv4 Statistics: The output of the **show ip dhcp server statistics** is used to verify that messages are being received or sent by the router. This command displays count information regarding the number of DHCPv4 messages that have been sent and received.

```
R1# show ip dhcp server statistics
Memory usage          19465
Address pools         1
Database agents       0
Automatic bindings    2
Manual bindings       0
Expired bindings      0
Malformed messages    0
Secure arp entries    0
Renew messages        0
Workspace timeouts    0
Static routes         0
Relay bindings        0
Relay bindings active      0
Relay bindings terminated  0
Relay bindings selecting  0
Message               Received
BOOTREQUEST           0
DHCPDISCOVER          4
DHCPREQUEST           2
DHCPDECLINE           0
DHCPRELEASE           0
DHCPINFORM            0
```

Configure a Cisco IOS DHCPv4 Server

Verify DHCPv4 is Operational (Cont.)

Verify DHCPv4 Client Received IPv4

Addressing: The **ipconfig**

/all command, when issued on PC1, displays the TCP/IP parameters, as shown in the example. Because PC1 was connected to the network segment 192.168.10.0/24, it automatically received a DNS suffix, IPv4 address, subnet mask, default gateway, and DNS server address from that pool. No DHCP-specific router interface configuration is required. If a PC is connected to a network segment that has a DHCPv4 pool available, the PC can obtain an IPv4 address from the appropriate pool automatically.

```
C:\Users\Student> ipconfig /all
Windows IP Configuration

Host Name . . . . . : ciscolab
Primary Dns Suffix . . . . . :
Node Type . . . . . : Hybrid
IP Routing Enabled. . . . . : No
WINS Proxy Enabled. . . . . : No

Ethernet adapter Ethernet0:

    Connection-specific DNS Suffix  . : example.com
    Description . . . . . : Realtek PCIe GBE Family Controller
    Physical Address. . . . . : 00-05-9A-3C-7A-00
    DHCP Enabled. . . . . : Yes
    Autoconfiguration Enabled . . . . : Yes
    IPv4 Address. . . . . : 192.168.10.10
    Subnet Mask . . . . . : 255.255.255.0
    Lease Obtained . . . . . : Saturday, September 14, 2019 8:42:22AM
    Lease Expires . . . . . : Sunday, September 15, 2019 8:42:22AM
    Default Gateway . . . . . : 192.168.10.1
    DHCP Server . . . . . : 192.168.10.1
    DNS Servers . . . . . : 192.168.11.5
```

Configure a Cisco IOS DHCPv4 Server

Disable the Cisco IOS DHCPv4 Server

The DHCPv4 service is enabled by default. To disable the service, use the **no service dhcp** global configuration mode command. Use the **service dhcp** global configuration mode command to re-enable the DHCPv4 server process, as shown in the example. Enabling the service has no effect if the parameters are not configured.

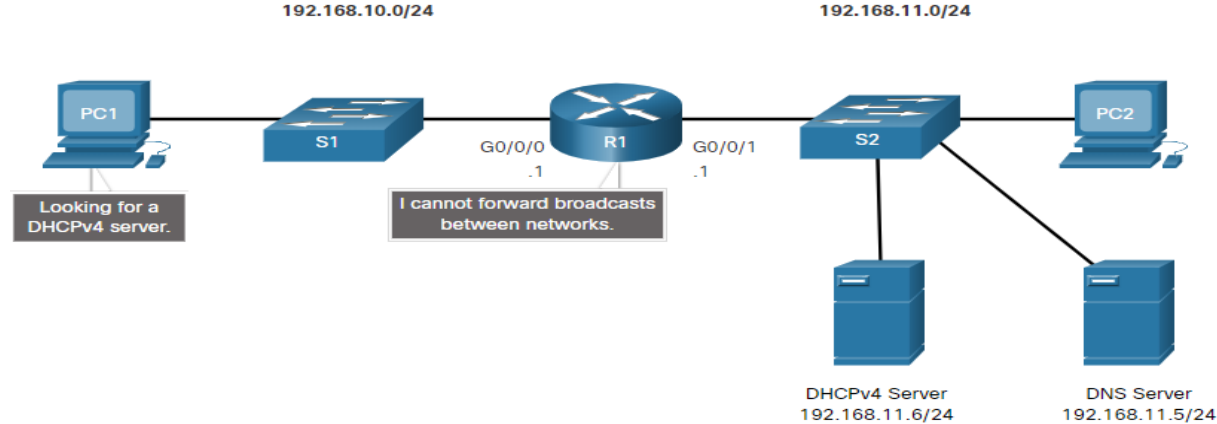
Note: Clearing the DHCP bindings or stopping and restarting the DHCP service may result in duplicate IP addresses being temporarily assigned on the network.

```
R1(config)# no service dhcp
R1(config)# service dhcp
R1(config)#
```

Configure a Cisco IOS DHCPv4 Server

DHCPv4 Relay

- In a complex hierarchical network, enterprise servers are usually located centrally. These servers may provide DHCP, DNS, TFTP, and FTP services for the network. Network clients are not typically on the same subnet as those servers. In order to locate the servers and receive services, clients often use broadcast messages.
- In the figure, PC1 is attempting to acquire an IPv4 address from a DHCPv4 server using a broadcast message. In this scenario, R1 is not configured as a DHCPv4 server and does not forward the broadcast. Because the DHCPv4 server is located on a different network, PC1 cannot receive an IP address using DHCP. R1 must be configured to relay DHCPv4 messages to the DHCPv4 server.



Configure a Cisco IOS DHCPv4 Server

DHCPv4 Relay (Cont.)

- Configure R1 with the **ip helper-address address** interface configuration command. This will cause R1 to relay DHCPv4 broadcasts to the DHCPv4 server. As shown in the example, the interface on R1 receiving the broadcast from PC1 is configured to relay DHCPv4 address to the DHCPv4 server at 192.168.11.6.
- When R1 has been configured as a DHCPv4 relay agent, it accepts broadcast requests for the DHCPv4 service and then forwards those requests as a unicast to the IPv4 address 192.168.11.6. The network administrator can use the **show ip interface** command to verify the configuration.

```
ipconfig /release
```

```
ipconfig /renew
```

```
R1(config)# interface g0/0/0
R1(config-if)# ip helper-address 192.168.11.6
R1(config-if)# end
R1#
```

```
R1# show ip interface g0/0/0
GigabitEthernet0/0/0 is up, line protocol is up
Internet address is 192.168.10.1/24
Broadcast address is 255.255.255.255
Address determined by setup command
MTU is 1500 bytes
Helper address is 192.168.11.6
(output omitted)
```

Configure a Cisco IOS DHCPv4 Server

Other Service Broadcasts Relayed

DHCPv4 is not the only service that the router can be configured to relay. By default, the **ip helper-address** command forwards the following eight UDP services:

- Port 37: Time
- Port 49: TACACS
- Port 53: DNS
- Port 67: DHCP/BOOTP server
- Port 68: DHCP/BOOTP client
- Port 69: TFTP
- Port 137: NetBIOS name service
- Port 138: NetBIOS datagram service

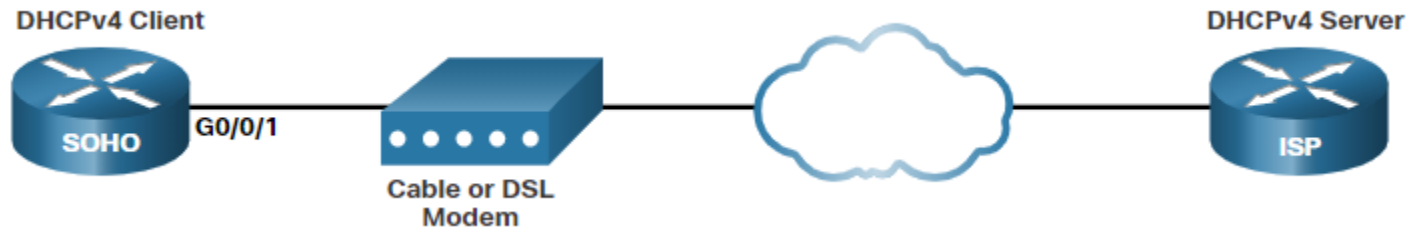
Configure a DHCPv4 Client

Configure a DHCPv4 Client

Cisco Router as a DHCPv4 Client

There are scenarios where you might have access to a DHCP server through your ISP. In these instances, you can configure a Cisco IOS router as a DHCPv4 client.

- Sometimes, Cisco routers in a small office or home office (SOHO) and branch sites have to be configured as DHCPv4 clients in a similar manner to client computers. The method used depends on the ISP. However, in its simplest configuration, the Ethernet interface is used to connect to a cable or DSL modem.
- To configure an Ethernet interface as a DHCP client, use the **ip address dhcp interface** configuration mode command.
- In the figure, assume that an ISP has been configured to provide select customers with IP addresses from the 209.165.201.0/27 network range after the G0/0/1 interface is configured with the **ip address dhcp** command.



Configure a DHCPv4 Client

Configuration Example

- To configure an Ethernet interface as a DHCP client, use the **ip address dhcp** interface configuration mode command, as shown in the example. This configuration assumes that the ISP has been configured to provide select customers with IPv4 addressing information.
- The **show ip interface g0/0/1** command confirms that the interface is up and that the address was allocated by a DHCPv4 server.

```
SOHO(config)# interface G0/0/1
SOHO(config-if)# ip address dhcp
SOHO(config-if)# no shutdown
Sep 12 10:01:25.773: %DHCP-6-ADDRESS_ASSIGN: Interface GigabitEthernet0/0/1 assigned DHCP address
209.165.201.12, mask 255.255.255.224, hostname SOHO
```

```
SOHO# show ip interface g0/0/1
GigabitEthernet0/0/1 is up, line protocol is up
  Internet address is 209.165.201.12/27
  Broadcast address is 255.255.255.255
  Address determined by DHCP
(output omitted)
```

Configure a DHCPv4 Client

Home Router as a DHCPv4 Client

Home routers are typically already set to receive IPv4 addressing information automatically from the ISP. This is so that customers can easily set up the router and connect to the internet.

- For example, the figure shows the default WAN setup page for a Packet Tracer wireless router. Notice that the internet connection type is set to **Automatic Configuration - DHCP**. This selection is used when the router is connected to a DSL or cable modem and acts as a DHCPv4 client, requesting an IPv4 address from the ISP.
- Various manufacturers of home routers will have a similar setup.

The screenshot displays the configuration interface for a 'Wireless Tri-Band Home Router'. At the top, the title 'Wireless Tri-Band Home Router' is shown on the left, and 'Firmware Version: v0.9.7' is on the right. Below this is a navigation bar with tabs: 'Setup' (selected), 'Wireless', 'Security', 'Access Restrictions', 'Applications & Gaming', 'Administration', and 'Status'. Under the 'Setup' tab, there are sub-tabs: 'Basic Setup', 'DNS', 'MAC Address Clone', and 'Advanced Routing'. The main content area is titled 'Internet Setup'. It features a dropdown menu for 'Internet Connection type' set to 'Automatic Configuration - DHCP'. Below this, under 'Optional Settings (required by some internet service providers)', there are input fields for 'Host Name', 'Domain Name', and 'MTU' (set to 1500). A 'Help...' link is located on the right side of the page.

Conclusion

- Application layer protocols are used to exchange data between programs running on the source and destination hosts. The presentation layer has three primary functions: formatting, or presenting data, compressing data, and encrypting data for transmission and decrypting data upon receipt. The session layer creates and maintains dialogs between source and destination applications.
- In the client/server model, the device requesting the information is called a client and the device responding to the request is called a server.
- In a P2P network, two or more computers are connected via a network and can share resources without having a dedicated server.
- The DHCPv4 server dynamically assigns, or leases, an IPv4 address to a client from a pool of addresses for a limited period of time chosen by the server, or until the client no longer needs the address.